

MODULE 02

Positioning: Stand Out in the Cohosting Market

Most new cohosts compete on price. They offer to take 15% when the market rate is 20-25%, believing that lower fees win owners. They don't. Lower fees signal desperation or inexperience. This module covers how to position on value so you can charge market rates from day one.

The owner is buying three things

An owner with a property they cannot or will not self-manage is not buying cleaning services or pricing optimization. They are buying three things, in this order of importance:

- **Time back.** The reason they want a cohost in the first place.
- **Confidence the property won't deteriorate.** Damage, bad reviews, neighbor complaints, fines from the city.
- **More revenue, without more work.** This is the secondary goal, not the primary.

If your positioning talks about pricing optimization and dynamic pricing algorithms as the lead message, you are leading with the least important thing. Lead with time back and peace of mind instead.

Pick a niche or stay generalist — both work

There are two viable paths for a new cohost:

Niche path: Become the obvious choice for a specific property type or owner situation. Examples: "cohost for remote owners", "Airbnb cohost for luxury cabins in the Smokies", "cohost for medical-stay furnished rentals". Niches win the listing audit because the owner sees their own situation in your examples.

Generalist path: Cover all STR property types in your city. This works if you can promise local responsiveness and have a strong network of cleaners and trades. Generalist cohosts win on operational reliability, not narrative specificity.

If you are starting, we recommend the niche path for the first 90 days. You can broaden later without losing the niche customers — they reference you to neighbors and friends who happen to own different property types.

Build your one-page positioning brief

Before you approach owners, write a single page that contains these five blocks. Keep it tight — you should be able to read it in 90 seconds.

Block 1 — Who I serve (one sentence). Example: "Remote-property owners in the Pacific Northwest who can't be on-site but want their cabin to be a real income source."

Block 2 — The specific problem I solve. Example: "Most remote owners have a property that gets forgotten about — calendar goes stale, reviews drop, revenue falls 30% year-over-year. I fix the calendar, the reviews, and the revenue."

Block 3 — How I work (the operational promise). Example: "I do a 24-hour response to every guest message. I send a monthly statement by the 5th of every month. I do a quarterly call to review performance."

Block 4 — The outcome (in the owner's words). Example: "My remote-owner clients say: I forgot I had a property until the statement arrived, and then the number was right."

Block 5 — Pricing model + minimum commit. Example: "25% of booking subtotal, 6-month minimum engagement, \$250 onboarding fee."

These five blocks work in your listing audit, in your website, in your first email to a prospect, and in your discovery call. The more places you use the same five blocks, the faster owners understand the fit.

What to leave off the page

Do not list every channel you can manage, every tool you have heard of, or every software you have tried. Owners do not care about your tool stack. They care about outcomes.

Module 02 — Done. Module 03 covers the cohost contract — the three fee models, the eight clauses you need, and the three clauses you negotiate hard.